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Research Portfolio

Reducing Discrimination in Customer–Employee Interactions

Problem: Discrimination impacted customer experience.
Approach: Mixed-method research (interviews, focus groups, ESG data).
Insights: Corporate purpose drives behavior change.
Impact: Improved CX consistency and business value.

ESG Dashboard Design for Decision-Making

Problem: Fragmented ESG data.
Approach: Stakeholder research + dashboard framework.
Insights: Centralized dashboards improve decisions.
Impact: Better alignment, transparency, and strategy.

User Segmentation in Second-Hand Market

Problem: Poor targeting.
Approach: Survey (600 users) + statistical segmentation.
Insights: Distinct user groups exist.
Impact: Improved personalization and product fit.

Predicting User Behavior with Decision Trees

Problem: User engagement drivers.
Approach: Decision tree modeling.
Insights: “Treasure hunting” drives engagement.
Impact: Better targeting and UX strategy.

Project 1: Reducing Discrimination in Customer–Employee Interactions

Project Overview

Designed a mixed-method UX research study to identify and reduce friction in customer–employee interactions caused by perceived discrimination in retail environments.

Problem

Retail experiences were negatively impacted by:

- Perceived discrimination among minority consumers
- Misalignment between employee behavior and company diversity initiatives
- Lack of actionable insights from existing training programs

My Role

- Led end-to-end research design and execution
- Conducted qualitative and quantitative research
- Synthesized insights into actionable experience improvements

Research Approach

Foundational Research

- Conducted:
    - Employee observations
    - Focus groups with frontline staff
    - Consumer interviews
    - Identified gaps between policy and real-world experience

Formative Research

- Analyzed employee perceptions of:
    - Psychological safety
    - Corporate purpose alignment
- Examined behavioral drivers of discrimination in interactions

Evaluative Research

- Validated findings using large-scale ESG + financial datasets
- Linked experience improvements to business outcomes (firm value)

Key Insights

- Employees were less likely to change behavior without a clear company purpose alignment
- Lack of psychological ownership reduced accountability and reporting of issues
- Employee experience directly influenced customer interaction quality

Impact on Product / Experience

- Identified scalable levers to improve customer experience consistency
- Enabled organizations to design purpose-driven interventions
- Demonstrated link between improved experience and business value (Tobin's Q increase)

Project 2: Designing ESG Dashboards for Data-Driven Decision Making

Project Overview

Led research to design and conceptualize ESG dashboards that enable organizations to monitor sustainability performance and support strategic decision-making.

Problem

Organizations struggled with:

- Fragmented ESG data across systems
- Lack of actionable insights from sustainability metrics
- Difficulty aligning stakeholder needs with reporting systems

My Role

- Synthesized research into productizable dashboard framework
- Defined user needs across stakeholder groups
- Translated insights into data visualization strategy

Research Approach

Foundational Research

- Identified stakeholder needs:
    - Executives → decision-making
    - Employees → engagement
    - Investors → risk assessment
- Defined ESG as multi-dimensional (environmental, social, governance)

Formative Research

- Developed framework for:
    - ESG metric selection
    - "Double materiality" (business + societal impact)
- Mapped user needs to dashboard features

Evaluative Research

- Assessed how dashboards:
    - Improve transparency
    - Enhance accountability
    - Enable faster decision-making

Key Insights

- Centralized dashboards improve data accessibility and usability
- ESG metrics must align with company purpose and strategy
- Visualization drives organizational adoption and behavior change

Impact on Product / Experience

- Defined blueprint for data dashboards used in strategic decision-making
- Improved cross-functional alignment (executives, employees, stakeholders)
- Enabled organizations to track performance, risks, and sustainability goals

Project 3: Segmenting Users Based on Behavioral Motivations (Second-Hand Market)

Project Overview

Conducted large-scale quantitative research to segment users based on behavioral motivations and improve targeting strategies across retail platforms.

Problem

Retailers treated second-hand shoppers as a single group, leading to:

- Ineffective targeting
- Poor personalization
- Suboptimal product-market fit

My Role

- Designed survey + analytical framework
- Led statistical modeling and segmentation
- Translated insights into user personas

Research Approach

Foundational Research

- Identified 6 key user motivations:
  - Frugality
  - Style consciousness
  - Ecological awareness
  - Dematerialism
  - Nostalgia
  - Fashion consciousness

Formative Research

- Collected data from 600 users across 3 platform types
- Applied profile analysis + ANOVA to detect behavioral differences

Evaluative Research

- Validated distinct user segments across:
  - Online platforms
  - Consignment stores
  - Thrift stores

Key Insights

- Users are not homogeneous—distinct segments exist
- Online users → more fashion + eco-conscious
- Thrift users → more dematerialistic
- All users share price sensitivity + style orientation

Impact on Product / Experience

- Enabled targeted personalization strategies
- Improved product positioning by user segment
- Informed platform-specific UX and merchandising decisions

Project 4: Predicting User Behavior Using Decision Tree Modeling

Project Overview

Developed a predictive model to understand key drivers of user engagement in retail environments.

Problem

Retailers lacked insight into:

- What drives repeat engagement
- Which users are high-value segments

My Role

- Built predictive model (decision tree)
- Identified key behavioral drivers
- Translated findings into actionable experience strategies

Research Approach

Foundational Research

- Identified two motivation types:
    - Self-oriented (e.g., treasure hunting)
    - Others-oriented (e.g., responsible citizenship)

Formative Research

- Collected data from 300+ users
- Built decision tree model using R

Evaluative Research

- Validated predictive accuracy (ROC ≈ 0.70)

Key Insights

- "Treasure hunting" was the strongest predictor of engagement
- Social responsibility also influenced behavior
- Different user segments respond to different motivations

Impact on Product / Experience

- Enabled predictive targeting of high-value users
- Informed experience design (e.g., discovery, surprise elements)
- Improved engagement strategies and retention models